

variants are compatible with Home. Nest, Philips Hue, TP-Link Smart Home and Vivint Home Security are some of the many third-party options. Nest is known for its thermostats, smoke detectors and security cameras. Philips Hue is a line-up of light bulbs that can be connected and customized to a central hub. TP-Link has an array of smart wall plugs that allow basic smart controls to any traditional appliance. Vivint sells a package



If only this could be made even more convenient

of home security solutions which include cameras, sensors and locks. A Canadian company, Smartika has some really interesting lighting solutions which are also compatible with IFTTT. Home's own compatibility with IFTTT boosts Smartika's usefulness. Home also fits into some of your existing smart home setups like SmartThings and Wink.

Conclusion

Google Home is a major step into home automation. Its compatibility is on par with that of Amazon Echo and then the amazing Google Assistant makes a remarkable addition. But it doesn't come without its drawbacks, the major one being, unlike an actual house, Home is a one-person device. As of the writing, it only connects with one Google account, which tosses other members of the house out of the picture. Want to update your to-do list? Consider it done. Someone else wants to update their to-do list? Nope! Then again this one is just the first iteration of Home series and Google has even announced their plans to fix this issue. How does Home actually compare to Echo? Both are powerful, yet both have their areas to shine. Home generally is better at answering questions due to Google's Support. But Echo is a better way to control your smart home just because it supports more hardware than Home. The next version of Home would definitely be a revolution on its own. And we look forward to what the future holds for this new member of the family. **d**